



Mostly cloudy 43/33 • Tomorrow: Mostly cloudy 55/40 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

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Senate to take up Trump’s voting bill

Far-reaching legislation to ‘guarantee’ midterms has no path to passage

BY THEODORIC MEYER

The Senate voted Tuesday to take up a far-reaching voting bill that President Donald Trump has demanded Congress pass before the midterms — but the legislation has no path to passing even as senators prepare for days of intense debate.

Senate Democrats have vowed to block the bill, known as the Save America Act, which they warn would make it harder to vote. The bill would require voters to prove they are U.S. citizens before registering to vote and to show photo identification when voting, among other provisions.

Republicans, who control the Senate, do not have the 60 votes they need to overcome a Democratic filibuster. Nor do they have enough votes to attempt a riskier gambit that some Republican senators favor: attempting to exhaust Democrats by forcing them to speak on the Senate floor for weeks to block the bill, known as a “talking filibuster.”

Instead, the Senate voted 51-48 to start debate on the bill, a vote that required only a majority. One Republican, Sen. Lisa Murkowski (Alaska), voted with Democrats against starting debate. Sen. Thom Tillis (R-North Carolina) did not vote.

Republicans are expected to spend days — potentially including nights and weekends — making the case for the bill on the Senate floor, according to two people familiar with the process, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe it.

“The votes aren’t there to do a talking filibuster,” Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-South Dakota) told reporters Tuesday. “So what we are doing is we are having a fulsome debate on the floor of the United States Senate.”

The expected marathon speeches will not bring Senate

SEE BILL ON A2

400 killed in airstrike on Afghan hospital



SAYED HASSIB/REUTERS

A man stands on debris Tuesday at the site of a hospital destroyed in what the Taliban said was a Pakistani airstrike in Kabul. Pakistan rejected Afghanistan’s accusation that it targeted the Omid Addiction Treatment center, insisting its strikes across eastern Afghanistan on Monday were against military facilities. **Story, A11**

Israel deals Iran significant blow, kills 2 senior officials

BY SUSANNAH GEORGE AND VICTORIA CRAW

Israel says it killed two of Iran’s most senior officials in overnight strikes, the most significant blow to the country’s wartime leadership since Iran’s supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, was killed at the outset of the conflict last month.

Ali Larjani, the secretary of the Supreme National Security Council of Iran, and Gholamreza Soleimani, commander of the Basij paramilitary, were “eliminated,” Israeli Defense Minister Israel Katz said in a statement Tuesday. Iranian state media lat-

er confirmed their deaths.

Larjani, who as Iran’s top security official was uniquely powerful in Iran, could be more difficult to replace than other military commanders killed in the U.S.-Israeli campaign against Iran, analysts said Tuesday. Over two weeks of punishing airstrikes have devastated Iranian military infrastructure but have not yet weakened the regime’s grip on power.

The United States imposed sanctions on Larjani in January in connection with Iran’s crackdown on protesters earlier this year, which left thousands of

SEE IRAN ON A9

First senior official openly breaks with White House

BY ELLEN NAKASHIMA, JOHN HUDSON, TARA COPP AND DAN LAMOTHE

The intelligence community’s top counterterrorism official said Tuesday he was stepping down over the U.S. and Israeli war on Iran — the first senior official to openly break ranks with the White House over a conflict stretching into its third week.

“After much reflection, I have decided to resign,” Joe Kent, the head of the National Counterterrorism Center, posted on X in a letter to President Donald

Trump. “I cannot in good conscience support the ongoing war in Iran.”

Kent continued: “Iran posed no imminent threat to our nation, and it is clear that we started this war due to pressure from Israel and its powerful American lobby.”

A staunch supporter of Trump, Kent was confirmed as NCTC director in July.

Kent’s resignation lays bare the schism within the Trump coalition between those who are skeptical of U.S. military interventions overseas and those who believe in the exercise of

SEE KENT ON A7

Public push, private doubts

ISRAEL ENCOURAGES IRANIANS TO REVOLT

But cable says citizens could be ‘slaughtered’

BY JOHN HUDSON

Senior Israeli officials have told U.S. diplomats that Iranian protesters will “get slaughtered” if they take to the streets against their government even as Israel publicly calls for a popular uprising, according to a State Department cable reviewed by The Washington Post.

The cable, circulated by the U.S. Embassy in Jerusalem on Friday, relayed an Israeli assessment that Iran’s regime is “not cracking” and is willing to “fight to the end” despite the Feb. 28 killing of Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei and the ongoing bombing campaign.

The regime killed thousands during anti-government demonstrations earlier this year. If large numbers of Iranians return to the streets, Israeli officials say “the people will get slaughtered” because the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, Iran’s principal military force, “has the upper hand,” according to the cable. The document’s authenticity was verified by two State Department officials.

Despite the grim forecast, Israeli officials said they hoped for a popular revolt and urged the United States to prepare to support protesters if that happens, according to the cable. The cable summarized recent meetings between U.S. officials and senior members of Israel’s National Security Council, Ministry of Defense and Ministry of Foreign Affairs on Wednesday and Thursday.

It comes as Iran’s exiled crown

SEE UPRISING ON A10

Betting on war: Online gamblers threaten journalist with death. **A14**

House panel subpoenas Bondi in Epstein inquiry

Attorney general ordered to appear April 14; Justice calls action ‘unnecessary’

BY MAEGAN VAZQUEZ

The House Oversight Committee has subpoenaed Attorney General Pam Bondi as part of its probe of the Justice Department’s investigation into deceased sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, ordering her to testify before the panel on April 14.

If Bondi honors the subpoena, she would face committee members’ questions in a closed-door session that could turn contentious, given the volatile nature of the Epstein case and Bondi’s demonstrated willingness to engage lawmakers in verbal combat.

A Justice Department official, however, quickly dismissed the subpoena as pointless, declining to say whether the attorney general would comply.

“This subpoena is completely

unnecessary,” said a Justice Department spokesperson. “Lawmakers have been invited to view the unredacted [Epstein] files for themselves at the Department of Justice, and the attorney general has always made herself available to speak directly with members of Congress.”

Bondi, along with her deputy Todd Blanche, are set to brief committee members on the Epstein matter Wednesday, the spokesperson noted, adding, “As always, we look forward to continuing to provide policymakers with the facts.”

The Oversight Committee took the vote on the subpoena earlier this month, moving to compel Bondi to appear for a deposition regarding the Justice Department’s handling of the investigation into Epstein and his associates in compliance with the Epstein Files Transparency Act, which required the agency to release all its files related to Epstein.

Rep. Nancy Mace (R-South Carolina) introduced the motion to consider the subpoena. Every

SEE BONDI ON A5

An Ivy League town is torn over affordable housing

Rooted in a 1970s anti-segregation law, New Jersey’s battle over growth is dividing neighbors

BY TIM CRAIG



HANNAH BEIER/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

“People direct a great deal of animosity, vitriol and hostility at me,” said Sacks, a Democrat, as she drove through Princeton last week. “People feel like we are trying to make their lives miserable, and it’s just been awful because they are really vicious.”

Across New Jersey, both residents and officials find themselves on the front lines of a nasty

SEE HOUSING ON A13

IN THE NEWS

Paperwork mistakes A rookie immigration officer fresh out of abbreviated training made critical paperwork errors that resulted in a man being detained for days in California. **A4**

Meteor explodes over Lake Erie The explosion produced a loud booming noise and even shook the ground near Cleveland. **A4**

THE NATION
European leaders rebuff President Donald Trump’s call to open the Strait of Hormuz. **A10**
The last pro-Palestinian protester detained by the Trump administration is released. **A5**

THE WORLD
The United States tells all its embassies to “immediately” review security after strikes. **A7**
Hezbollah has angered its Shiite political base in Lebanon with new war against Israel. **A8**

THE ECONOMY
Oil prices resume their rise, but U.S. stocks are holding steadier. **A14**
Generation X is facing economic instability. **A12**

SPORTS
The NCAA tournament will offer a riveting stage for a deep class of freshmen rife with NBA talent. **B7**

STYLE
Trump 2.0 was supposed to be younger and cooler, but the vibes have shifted as MAGA may be entering its cringe phase. **B1**
Lost cause? The Oscars can’t get past their contradictions. So enjoy the ceremony for what it is while it lasts. **B1**

THE REGION
A man convicted of shooting D.C. officer Brian Gibson in 2019 is seeking an early release from prison under a controversial law. **B13**
At least 10 ICE arrests of immigrants in the District involved U.S. Park Police, records show. **B13**

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